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Mo

Molybdenum

Forms

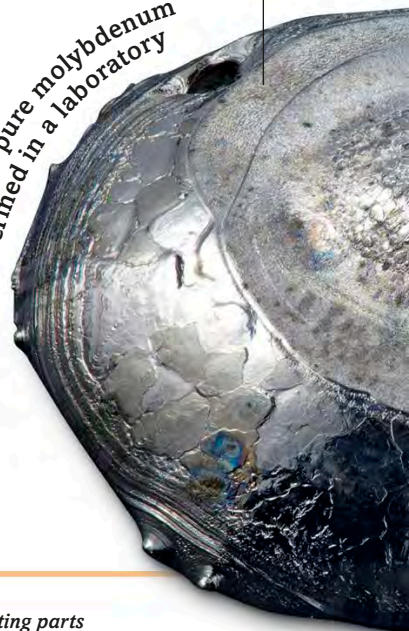
Molybdenite



This mineral feels greasy to the touch.

This metal's pure form is silver-grey and has a very high melting point: 2,623°C (4,753°F).

Chunk of pure molybdenum refined in a laboratory



Uses

This slippery lubricant, which contains finely powdered molybdenite mixed with oil, protects fast-moving mechanical parts in engines.

Lubricant



This lightweight but stiff frame is made from a steel containing molybdenum and chromium.

Chrome-Moly steel bike



These closely fitting parts are hard so they do not get damaged easily.



Ratchet set



Molybdenum gets its unusual name from the Greek word *molybdos*, which means “lead”. Miners once mistook **molybdenite**, a dark mineral containing this metal, for an ore of lead. This element is much harder than lead, so it is easy to distinguish

between these two elements when they are pure. Molybdenite is soft and slippery, and it is the main molybdenum ore. **Pure molybdenum** is mainly used to make alloys that are resistant to corrosion. These are lightweight so are ideal for constructing **bike frames**, but